the big-spending lobbyists who maneuvered for favors from the legislature. In the past, he had usually gotten his way with Pat Brown.

From my viewpoint, Unruh represented many of the things I thought were wrong with government. From his viewpoint, I must have seemed like an inexperienced and naive alien trying to force my way into what he and his cronies thought of as their private club, with an exclusive franchise for spending the taxpayers' money.

Over time, I gained some grudging respect for Unruh's skills as a legislative tactician—he was good at what he did—but he put partisanship above all else and never took prisoners.

I have often wondered about a paradox in American government: Every four years, voters elect a president and in California a governor, the only officeholders elected by *all* the people; then, the same people in their individual districts turn around and elect a legislature and congress that is often controlled by the opposing party, enabling it to prevent the president or governor from carrying out the things they elected him or her to do.

I know some people think this is good because they consider it as part of our system of checks and balances. Well, if that's the case, why don't we have a Republican legislature more often when we have a Democratic governor? Every ten years, after each census, the boundaries of our electoral districts are redrawn during the reapportionment process. And for most of the past half century, a single party—the Democrats—have been in power and they have used this power to draw the boundaries of electoral districts in such a blatantly partisan fashion that the districts seldom have reflected the real political sentiment in much of the nation. As a result, a lot of the effects of that prairie fire I've mentioned—the quiet revolution in which middle-class Americans have tried to